A-A-53682
16 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ROD, STIRRING, LABORATORY
Polytetraflouroethylene

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-R-0036579 which will be canceled.

This commercial item description covers polytetraflouroethylene coated stirring rods used in laboratory procedures for manually mixing or stirring corrosive materials.

Salient characteristics.

The stirring rods shall be made of polytetraflouroethylene with an annealed steel core to provide strength and to permit bending into various shapes. The ends shall be rounded.

The stirring rods shall be furnished in the following sizes:

Size I	6.0 inches long, 3/16 inch diameter
Size II	10.0 inches long, 1/4 inch diameter

The thickness of the polytetraflouroethylene shall be at least 1/16 inch.

The Size I stirring rod shall have a steel core, 0.063 inch in diameter. (16 gage Washburn and Moen)

The Size II stirring rod shall have a steel core, 0.106 inch in diameter. (12 gage Washburn and Moen)

Flexibility shall be such that the rod can be bent with hand pressure. Rigidity shall be such that the equivalent hand pressure is required to straighten the bent rod. There shall be no cracks, tears or flaking of the coating when the rod is bent by hand 180 degrees around a 1-1/2 inch diameter mandrel and straightened by hand a total of 5 times.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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The stirring rod shall show no change in physical appearance when exposed to highly corrosive reagents.

Workmanship. The rods shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One rod, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspections and tests. Sampling for inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one stirring rod.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6640-00-127-0129	Size II
6640-00-127-0130	Size I

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1502

Location: Disk No. 13

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53682	ROD, STIRRING, LABORATORY Polytetraflouroethylene

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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